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Purpose of an assessment brief

(How should I use this brief to help with my assessment?)

This brief gives you key information and guidance about your assessment. It's the starting point for your work, and your module tutors will refer to it during assessment discussions. Read the brief carefully, along with any other materials your tutors provide, and use them to help you plan and complete your assessment.

1.0 Essential Information

Module Code and Title	DG1IAD Internet Applications and Databases
Module/Assessment Lead contact	wangh25@aston.ac.uk and a.giagkos@aston.ac.uk
Assessment Title	Portfolio3
Assessment Weighting	30%
Submission Date and Time	4:00pm 27th March 2026
Word Count/Page Count/Lengths of presentation/ Fixed Window Assessment Period (in hours/days)	Project Report– no more than 2 pages

2.0 Assessment Overview

Assessment Mode (What do I need to produce at the end?)

You are asked to create a CV Database Website and deployed to the host server. You should submit your source code and a summary report about your website.

Task Description (What do I have to do for this assessment?)
Problem Statement

You are asked to create AstonCV, a CV database website to demonstrate your understanding of the server-side development knowledge covered in Unit 7- 10. The AstonCV should be a dynamic database-driven web application aiming to host CVs of programmers. One user could register on the website and then log in to add their CV. All CVs are open to be viewed and searched on this website by any users.

Descriptive details of Assignment:

Database

All CVs are stored at a backend MySQL database. Each CV should have the user's account information and basic curriculum vitae information including *name, email, password, education, key programming language, profile, URL links* etc.
One SQL script, ***cvs.sql***, is provided on Blackboard which you can use to create one database table, called **cvs**. The given columns in the table should be enough for this portfolio.

You are free to design and extend your database table(s). You should populate the table(s) manually or automatically with some data entries for testing purpose.

Server-side Implementation (85 marks)

Your implementation should choose to use one (or more) server-side programming language covered in the module including vanilla PHP, object-oriented PHP, Laravel framework and Node.js in combination with HTML and other front-end technologies. You need to implement all the functional requirements listed below. Your implementation should also consider some essential security features for all web applications.

Functional Requirements for public (30 marks)

- View a list of all the CVs showing basic information (e.g., name, email, key programming language)
- Click one CV in the list to view the CV details (basic information + education, profile, links etc.)
- Search all CVs using name or key programming language
- Register to become a registered user

Functional Requirements for registered users (30 marks)

- Log in the system
- Update your CV by inputting more details
- Logout the system

Security Measures (20 marks)

At least 5 security measures should be implemented in your website development. Some examples:

- Authentication
- Authorization
- Form validation
- Handle injections (SQL/HTML)
- Hash password
- Cross-Site Request Forgery

Good coding practice (5 marks)

- The website should follow the good coding practices demonstrated in the module.

User Interface (5 marks)

The user interface must be easy and convenient to use. One webpage should have links pointing to the main page or related pages; the page should be readable with appropriate text font, size, colour and background colour. The webpage should be clean and tidy. The names of the links should be descriptive; the output and information should be in adequate descriptive text and neat, clear format.
You are free to use any front-end technologies (HTML, CSS and any templates, JavaScript and any libraries etc.) for the user interface. It is suggested that you could use some of the web pages designed in your Portfolio1.

Project Report (10 marks)

You must write and submit a short project report in PDF format which should be no longer than 2 pages and be written in clear English. You are suggested to use **the report template** provided on Blackboard. The report MUST include the following items in the order of:

- Basic information:
    - Your name and students ID

- A hyperlink to the entry page of your system on a host server.
- One user's username and password of your website.
- If applicable, an open GitHub (or to others) web link for your source code.

- List the required functions you have implemented and the main corresponding source file(s) so examiners could find them when needed.
- List the security features you have used and point out the main corresponding source file(s) so examiners could find them when needed.
- Other things which need the examiner's attention when running your website should also be described if applicable.
- You should avoid including the screenshots of your website in the report.
- Missing the required information and unclear description in the report could lead to mark deduction.

Submission Instructions (When and Where do I submit?)

- You should submit this portfolio via the module's Assessment Submission area on Blackboard **due by 4:00 pm, on Friday 27th of March 2026**.
- Submit your portfolio report in PDF format on Blackboard. If you do not submit your report on Blackboard, your work will not be marked. If you do not have the required information in the report, your mark could be deducted.
- Submit a separate ZIP file of your website on Blackboard. You need to zip your main source code and database into one ZIP file. Alternatively, you could list a GitHub (or to others) link in your report which can be checked by examiners.
- Deploy your application to one host server in order for examiners to run and evaluate your web application. You could use the internal host server *http://<yourusername>.cs2410-web01pvm.aston.ac.uk* or an external host of your own choice. The guidance documents about deployment on the internal host server have been published on Blackboard. If you fail to deploy your website/database onto one host server, examiners will not be able to run your web application, and your work will not be marked!
- Your web application will be checked using Chrome browser. You need to make your website work in Chrome.
- Standard lateness penalties will apply for late submissions based on the University regulations.
- Please reference this **guide to submitting to Blackboard assignments.**

Please note:

- Your submission must be your own effort. Copying and sharing work is forbidden. If you are found to have copied or shared your submission, your mark may be reduced or set to zero (or worse).
- Any changes, uploads, or edits to the server code after the deadline will result in a lateness penalty being applied according to the standard university regulations.
- Extensions will only be granted if approved in accordance with the university's Exceptional Circumstances process.

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3.0 Purpose of Assessment

Link to Learning Outcomes (How does the assessment help you demonstrate the outcomes of this module?)

This portfolio links to the module learning outcomes:

LO2: Design and implement web applications using server-side scripting languages and associated frameworks and libraries;
LO4: Integrate database, client- and server-side technologies to create and deploy a secure and performant database-driven web application.

Purpose of Assessment

The rationale behind this task is to create the opportunity for you to practise and develop what you have been learning in the module into a real web application. This work requires you to design a CV website following the given requirements. Through this process, you will enhance the back-end web deveopment knowledge and strengthen full-stack web development techinical skills. The feedback you receive from this assessment could inform your potential improvement and future work on web application development.

4.0 Feedback Expectations

When and where can I find my grades and feedback?

Staff will aim to return provisional marks for coursework assessments to students within 4 weeks of the submission deadline during term time.

For this module, summative feedback and provisional grade will be released no later than 24th April 2026 via Gradebook in Blackboard. Please select your assignment to view your feedback report.

Any grades that you see outside of **My Aston Portal (MAP)** should be thought of as provisional. Only final Exam Board approved grades will appear in MAP. Feedback and provisional grades can be accessed in Blackboard for both Turnitin and Blackboard Assignments.

5.0 Guidance on AI Usage

Can I use AI in my work and how?

Use of Gen AI is prohibited	For this assessment, use of generative AI is prohibited. You must not use generative AI technology to support your work on this assessment in any way. Misuse of generative AI, as defined in Aston's assessment regulations, will be treated as an academic offence and may be subject to disciplinary action. You may find this guidance by The Learning Services team on the effective and ethical use of AI for assessment useful: Artificial Intelligence for study and assessment | Rise 360

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6.0 Assessment Top Tips

What further information and advice might help me to complete this task?

- Read the task description and make sure that you follow the requirements.
- Any questions, please check the DG1IAD Module's Discussion forum first.
- You can reference the following resources:
  - ✓ DG1IAD Blackboard Module > Units 7-10
  - ✓ DG1IAD Reading List
  - ✓ W3schools.com
  - ✓ Php.net
- Please review the following **checklist** before your submission:
  - ✓ Deploy your website on a host server (are the website live on a host server working properly?).
  - ✓ Write your project report with the required information (using the given template).
  - ✓ Submit your report in PDF format on Blackboard.
  - ✓ Submit your source code archived in a single ZIP file on Blackboard.

7.0 Assessment Criteria and Rubrics

General Marking Scheme:

0-19 Fragmentary or almost wholly ineffective activity.

20-39 Work that provides evidence of relevant knowledge and cs deployed on such a limited scale or in such an ineffective manner that the threshold standard for the module has not been achieved. For example, some major components present but missing major functionality, styling or validation, or the website satisfies few or none of the identified objectives and/or is totally compromised by lack of usability.

Work meeting the threshold standard required by the module, but by reason of lack of scope or proportion or scale of flaws, not achieving the target standard.

40-49 Expected activities have been undertaken, but at a minimal standard of competence and understanding leading to barely acceptable outcomes: e.g., expected development activities are pursued, but in such a way as to lead to working prototype that meets a limited subset of the original objectives and is seriously flawed.

50-59 Expected activities have been undertaken in a manner that shows a clear grasp of what is required and leads to a broadly acceptable working website. There may, however, be significant weaknesses, e.g., limited scope, unsatisfactory usability, poor organization, etc.

Work of the target standard for the module spanning a range from good to excellent.

60-69 Work producing a sound deliverable: for example, a website substantially meeting the assessment objectives, with no major flaws. The scope of the work reasonably reflects the student hours appropriate to the weight of the assessment and the credit value of the module.

70-79 Work distinguished by evidence of a deeper level of understanding, insight and innovation, and with very few (if any) clear flaws. All requirements have been completed to a very high standard.

80+ Exceptional work approximating a professional standard that a member of academic staff would be satisfied to have produced themselves.

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